

Jiaen Wu

PhD Candidate, Public Affairs

O'Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs, Indiana University Bloomington

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Research Interests

Public management; bureaucratic discretion; AI and algorithmic governance; representative bureaucracy; health management; causal inference.

Education

Indiana University Bloomington

Ph.D. in Public Affairs, Expected May 2027

2022–Present

Bloomington, IN

- Major field: Public Management; minor field: Policy Analysis
- Dissertation: *Balancing Bureaucratic Discretion: The Role of Diversity, Policy, and AI in Public Governance*
- Committee: Amanda Rutherford (Chair), Jill Nicholson-Crotty, Tom Rabovsky, Coady Wing

National Taiwan University

MS in Public Policy

2019–2021

Taipei

- Advisor: Ming-Feng Kuo

University of California, Berkeley

Visiting Student

2019–2020

California

National Taiwan University

BS in Political Science

2016–2019

Taipei

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Wu, Jiaen. 2026. "Routinized Deference: Predictive Screening and Bureaucratic Capacity in Child Protective Services." *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*. Conditional acceptance.

Zhu, Xiaochun, **Jiaen Wu**, and Sewon Kim. 2026. "Symbolic Gesture or Substantive Change? Gender Budgeting and Sectoral Allocations in the OECD." *Public Budgeting & Finance*, 1–24.

Rutherford, Amanda, and **Jiaen Wu**. 2025. "Representation and the Legislative Enterprise: An Expanded View of Staff Representation." *Politics, Groups, and Identities*, 1–27.

Wu, Jiaen, and Ming-Feng Kuo. 2024. "How Conjoint Analysis Contributes to Mitigating Intergroup Conflict? A Case Study of Ageing Policy in Taipei City, Taiwan." *Journal of Asian Public Policy*, 725–746.

Under Review

Wu, Jiaen. "From Boardroom Representation to Workplace Leadership: Evaluating the Effects of California's Gender Quota Legislation on Female Career Advancement." Under review.

Wu, Jiaen. "Does Discretion Enable Active Representation? Evidence from the 2022 Expansion of WOSB-Eligible Industries." Under review.

Wu, Jiaen and Amanda Rutherford. "Is GPT a Good Civil Servant? The Evaluation of Artificial Discretion by Large Language Models." Under review.

Wu, Jiaen and Amanda Rutherford. "Augmenting the Bureaucrat: How AI Exposure Shapes Job Satisfaction in Public Agencies." Under review.

Santiago, Karl, Kyuwoong Kyeong, and **Jiaen Wu**. "Different Ways of Doing Good: Public Service Motivation and Ethical Judgment in Public Administration." Under review.

Works in Progress

Rutherford, Amanda, Jiyoung Jun, Apoorva Gurtu, and **Jiaen Wu**. "Do You Dare Consider Public Service? Unpacking How Job Attributes Shape Applications to the U.S. Federal Government."

Wu, Jiaen, Karl Santiago, and Kyuwoong Kyeong. "Trust in the Makers, Not the State: Corruption and

Citizens' Fairness Expectations of AI in Government.”

Wu, Jiaen, Nicole Siegal, Christopher Whaley, Jay Shrok, Stephen Crystal, Jennifer Miles, Hillary Samples, Kosali Simon, and Sumedha Gupta. “Buprenorphine Prescribing Trends and Practice Environment Associations with Clinician Adoption.”

Wu, Jiaen and Karl Santiago. “Transparency Mandates and Nonprofit Governance: Evidence from Board Demographic Disclosure in Illinois.”

Research Grants

2026 **AI at Work Grant (Principal Investigator)**, Schmidt Sciences. Award amount: \$200,000.

2026 **Top Grant (Principal Investigator)**, National Science and Technology Council (Taiwan). Award amount: \$30,000.

Fellowships and Honors

2026–2027 **Irsay Graduate Fellows Program**, Indiana University Bloomington

2026–2027 **Alan Brass Ph.D. Fellowship in Public Affairs**, Indiana University Bloomington O’Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs

2026 **Staats Emerging Scholars Award**, Network of Schools of Public Policy, Affairs, and Administration (NASPAA)

2026 **Travel Grant Award**, American Political Science Association Public Policy Section

2026 **Dissertation Workshop Series - Public Administration and Policy**, American Political Science Association

2026 **Summer Academy**, Department of Public Administration & Policy, American University

2025–2026 **Alan Brass Ph.D. Fellowship in Public Affairs**, Indiana University Bloomington O’Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs

2024 **ICPSR Tuition Fellowship**, Indiana University Bloomington O’Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs

2022–2024 **Fulbright Student Grantee**, Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs, U.S. Department of State

Teaching Experience

SPEA-V379: Performance Measurement and Program Evaluation

Instructor of Record

Fall 2026
Indiana University Bloomington

SPEA-V185: Management of Public Problems and Solutions

Instructor of Record

Spring 2025
Indiana University Bloomington

GIPA-7008: Applied Statistics for Social Science Research

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2021
National Taiwan University

Conference Presentations

Wu, Jiaen and Amanda Rutherford. “Who Ends Up Serving? Job Postings and the Demographic Composition of Federal Hires.” 2026. American Political Science Association Annual Meeting.

Wu, Jiaen. “Does Discretion Enable Active Representation? Evidence from the 2022 Expansion of WOSB-Eligible Industries.” 2026. Public Management Research Conference.

Rutherford, Amanda, Jiyoung Jun, Apoorva Gurtu, and **Jiaen Wu**. “Do You Dare Consider Public Service? Unpacking How Job Attributes Shape Applications to the U.S. Federal Government.” 2026. Public Management Research Conference.

Wu, Jiaen and Amanda Rutherford. “Augmenting the Bureaucrat: How AI Exposure Shapes Job Satisfaction in Public Agencies.” 2026. Midwest Political Science Association.

Freedman, Seth, Kosali Simon, Nicole Siegal, Coady Wing, and **Jiaen Wu**. “Physician Labor Mobility Post-Dobbs.” 2025. Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management.

Wu, Jiaen. “Artificial Discretion in Action: The Effects of Predictive Screening Algorithms on Child Protec-

tive Services Outcomes.” 2025. Public Management Research Conference.

Wu, Jiaen. “From Boardroom Representation to Workplace Leadership: Evaluating the Effects of California’s Gender Quota Legislation on Female Career Advancement.” 2025. Midwest Political Science Association.

Wu, Jiaen and Amanda Rutherford. “Is GPT a Good Civil Servant? The Evaluation of Artificial Discretion by Large Language Models.” 2024. Public Management Research Conference.

Zhu, Xiaochun, **Jiaen Wu**, and Sewon Kim. “Gender Budgeting and Fiscal Performance: Evaluating Its Impact on National Deficits Across OECD Countries.” 2024. Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management.

Rutherford, Amanda, and **Jiaen Wu.** “Active Representation and the Legislative Bureaucracy: Studying the Effects of Congressional Staff.” 2024. Midwest Political Science Association.

Wu, Jiaen and Amanda Rutherford. “Is GPT a Good Civil Servant? The Evaluation of Artificial Discretion by Large Language Models.” 2024. Annual O’Neill Ph.D. Student Conference. *Conference Best Paper Award.*

Rutherford, Amanda, and **Jiaen Wu.** “Political Pressure vs. Representation and the Composition of Congressional Staff.” 2023. American Political Science Association.

Rutherford, Amanda, and **Jiaen Wu.** “Who Do Legislators Hire? The Motivation of Political Representatives in Congress.” 2023. Annual O’Neill Ph.D. Student Conference.

Academic Training and Workshops

Inter-University Consortium for Political and Social Research	2024
Theoretical Modeling for the Social and Behavioral Sciences	Michigan

Institute for Political Methodology, Academia Sinica	2020
Causal Inference	Taipei

Democracy Camp, University of California, Berkeley	2020
Government and Philanthropy Interviews	California

Methods and Software

Causal inference; conjoint experiments; survey experiments; large-scale administrative data; text-as-data; R; Stata; Python; LaTeX.

Professional and University Service

Referee: *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*, *Public Management Review*, *Public Budgeting & Finance*, and *International Journal of Public Sector Management*.

President, O’Neill Ph.D. Student Association, Indiana University Bloomington, 2024–2025.

Professional Memberships

Public Management Research Association; Midwest Political Science Association; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management.